

OREGON CITY COURIER

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Published Thursdays from the Courier Building, Eighth Street, and entered in the Postoffice at Oregon City, Ore., as 2nd class mail matter.

Subscription Price \$1.50.

Telephones: Pacific 51; Home A-51.

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CONGRESSIONAL PROBLEMS

Congress probably has to go slow in the consideration of the several war measures that are before congress at the present session and those which will be presented, but congress will see the failure of its plans if it attempts to go too slow. Just now both houses are working over-time on plans for increasing the standing army. An additional army of 500,000 soldiers has been authorized.

On the one hand President Wilson and those working with the administration are as strong for the selective draft plan for recruiting troops as the majority of the military committee in the house is for volunteer forces. The debate upon the question is heated this week.

The volunteer plan has failed to work successfully in connection with the national guard and the regular army. In the present crisis the war department was forced to stop recruiting in the national guard because the regular army could not draw enough men to fill its ranks to war strength.

What would be the spectacle if the nation attempted to furnish 500,000 additional troops under any volunteer plan? It appears that the only way out is through the selective draft bill.

The draft measure will force an able-bodied intelligent young man to sacrifice three years of his life in the name of patriotism for \$15 a month and food, but the volunteer system never will. The present war crisis is not to be everlasting, but America has learned her lesson and in future, if wise minds guide the destinies of the nation, we shall be prepared for any eventuality. Therefore, we must have the strong standing forces that have been authorized. Of course, should congress take steps to pay for a man's service somewhere within reason, the army and navy can call men as volunteers. Otherwise the impossibility of the thing is manifest.

Training camps are being established at several of the larger army posts throughout the nation. The cream of America's young manhood is called to the colors to train for commissions that there may be leaders for the additional troops that are to be provided. In nine cases out of ten the class of young men who are qualified for attendance at these training camps are educated beyond the average in book lore and are occupying better positions in civil life than the general average of men of their age. Yet, the government asks these men to attend a training camp for three months, sacrificing their civil positions and prospects, and get nothing for the service other than a promise of a commission in case their service is needed at the end of the training period. Such service not being needed most of these young men will turn back to where they started in civil life years ago. Without work, without funds, they will return to civil life.

Under such a plan the first set of camps may be successful while the spirit of patriotism burns bright. But the second series of camps will be an abject failure simply because young Americans cannot afford the sacrifice that in many cases means years from their lives. Congress must also solve that problem and do it speedily if it is to get the class of army and navy officers it would have to lead the new and greater forces of the nation.

THE TEARS AND THE VOTE

Woman's first vote in the American congress was bathed in tears.

And almost suggestive of a peculiar coincidence, or a decree of Fate, it was cast upon the one issue most near the maternal heart of woman: The issue of war or peace!

Men furnish the money for war; but women the sons who do the fighting and the dying!

Naturally, then—quite naturally—it is the woman's heart that is touched closest by war.

And when Miss Rankin's name

was called in the house voting in the small hours of Friday morning, the "lady from Montana," put to the fire of casting her maiden vote in congress, arose in her place and said through sobs:

"I want to stand by my country, but I cannot vote for war!"

Of course, Miss Rankin cried. And why shouldn't she have done so?

The fact that she shed tears when she cast her first vote as the first woman who ever sat in congress with the eyes of the whole house and the whole republic upon her, at the end of an extraordinarily long and strenuous sitting, a nerve-racking ordeal, and such a stupendous question at issue—the fact that she wept does not prove her weak.

Indeed, the ordeal was enough to make a strong man weep. It simply proved her womanly!

After all, behind those tears was a woman's heart!

Back of them was the sacred maternal instinct; the womanly sentiment; the inherent feminine love of peace, tranquility and the devotion of the fireside.

Some good day, somewhere, somehow, the very sentiment back of those tears and which prompted them is going to control the world! And when it does, there will be an end to war; there will be no more bloodshed on the battlefield; no more calling of mothers' sons to go down into blood-soaked trenches and engage in the death grapple with other mothers' sons!

Unfortunately, up to this time the world—civilization—has not reached that stage—but it is coming, and the women are going to help bring it about.

The tears that moved Miss Rankin will some day move the women of all the world—at a time when they will demand that they be consulted before their "war lords" tear their sons from their bosoms.

And when that day comes there will be no war.—Atlanta (Ga.) Constitution.

SQUELCH THE SPECULATOR

The sudden jump in the retail prices of such foods as bread, butter, flour and sugar startles the community and makes thoughtful persons look ahead and think of relief from the national government. The 5-cent loaf of 10 ounces has given way to the 18-ounce loaf at 10 cents. Butter costs the consumer 50 cents a pound. Flour advanced 45 cents a barrel on Monday. Sugar retails at 10 cents a pound.

There seems to be no justification for these sharp and sudden advances. The excuses put forth in attempted explanation fail to convince the public. There has been no known shortage of staples thus far. The increased cost added to the prices of foods last week and this is suspiciously suggestive of speculation, manipulation and "corners."

The thing for the people to do at present is to economize on food as much as and wherever practical and to use the boycott. The next step is to take such action as that of the associated committees of benevolent, fraternal and labor organizations which consider the high cost of living and federal action to regulate prices. The national government owes it to the people to warn speculators in food without delay that it will act against them immediately. Then there should be established some national commission, analogous to the Hoover commission which fed the Belgians, to look after the people's food and its prices in the United States. The experience of England, France and Germany in this matter shows what the government should do and can do. The time to prevent possible suffering is now, and the national government is the proper agency to serve the people in this matter.—Spokane-Review.

GOOD ROADS AGAIN

Good roads concern and should interest every citizen. They reduce the cost per ton to the producer in mar-

keting his products. This is an important factor in determining the ultimate cost to the consumer. Good roads mean a substantial saving in the operating cost of 36,000 motor vehicles in this state and will effect a further saving of at least 10 per cent in the department of all vehicles. These two items amount into almost incredible sums annually.

All money raised for good roads will be expended in this state, contributing to the welfare of all. Good roads increase the value of all land contiguous to the highways that are improved. This stimulates road construction in other communities. Could more material reasons be urged for supporting the good roads bond bill at the special election June 4?

Good roads are indispensable to the progress and prosperity of any state or community. Such improvements attract the tourist, encourage local development, promote social life, improve market conditions and stimulate thrift. Rural life is made more attractive and agricultural development is advanced in proportion as accessible roads are established and maintained. The further settlement and development of the state's unutilized lands add to their value. The consequent increase in assessable values gives assurance of reduced taxes. Support the good roads bond bill June 4 and thereby assist to effect these conditions.—Good Roads Committee.

HAZELIA

(Too late for regular page)

The hard times social given at the school house Saturday evening was a decided success. A long program was given and was greatly enjoyed by all. Later refreshments were sold. The prizes were awarded to Miss Dora Oldstadt of Stafford and Vernon Davidson of Hazelia. The proceeds of the evening amounted to about \$22.

Remember that Literary meets Saturday evening, April 28. A program is being prepared. All are most cordially invited to attend.

F. H. Childs was a Portland visitor on Wednesday.

Mr. and Mrs. A. E. Helms and sons, Charles and Raymond, were visiting in the Rose City Saturday.

Mr. and Mrs. F. W. Lehman and children spent the day with Mrs. Stella Shipley of Oswego Sunday.

Misses Lulu and Hattie Wanker were pleasantly entertained by Mrs. F. H. Childs Wednesday evening.

Mr. and Mrs. John Raicy were visitors in Tualatin Meadows Sunday.

J. Fiala was a business visitor in Portland Saturday.

Willie and Eddie Hendrickson, of Oswego, called upon their teacher, Miss Lucille Duncan, Sunday.

O. C. Whitten spent Saturday in Oregon City.

A large crowd from Stafford was present at the hard times social given here Saturday night.

A. Worthington was in Portland Saturday.

Miss Lulu Wanker, Mrs. A. Nielson and F. H. Childs were from Hazelia who were in Portland Monday.

Mrs. F. E. Whitten and Miss Iva Whitten were shopping in Oregon City Friday.

Misses Bonnie and Irene Duncan spent Sunday afternoon in Tualatin Meadows.

Hattie and Edith Wanker were guests of their cousin, Miss Wanda Wanker, Sunday.

KAISER MAY DO IT

Said to Have Paled When Abduction is Suggested to Him

The Corriere d'Italia, the clerical organ, declares that it is able to confirm reports, published in the Spanish newspapers, that the immediate following of the German emperor is exerting pressure on him to abdicate. The paper says that at a recent meeting of the Hohenzollern family, one member, bolder than the rest, intimated that the emperor might save the situation by following the example of Emperor Nicholas.

The German monarch is reported to have turned pale and, after observing that the general opinion was against him, left the room, muttering, "We shall see." The same evening he summoned another family council. The chancellor and some of the ministers were present, but whatever passed remains unknown.

Little importance is attached to this story in Italian political circles. In these quarters it is thought that the story has a German origin and is put out with the intention of influencing opinion.

DR. MATSON LECTURES

Has Crowded Hall for Lecture on Red Cross Battle Work

Dr. Ralph C. Matson, of the British medical reserves, talked to a crowded house at the Busch hall Tuesday night under the auspices of the Red Cross society of this city. His lecture was illustrated with slides made from battlefield pictures and he talked about the work of the Red Cross on the European fields, reviewing his activities in detail and telling of the new methods of treatment for injuries that have been developed in Europe since the war started.

Mrs. E. E. Brodie sang the "Star Spangled Banner" and James H. Cary made a brief patriotic address. Following the meeting many people signed the membership roll of the Red Cross society and the total membership was brought to above 2505 persons.

Relief Corps to Join

The Women's Relief corps held its regular meeting at Willamette hall Tuesday afternoon and commemorated the birthday anniversaries of those of its members who were born in April. The corps will co-operate in any possible way with the local Red Cross society, it was agreed yesterday. The corps also decided to join with the G. A. R. in attending memorial services at the Congressional church on Memorial day.

BRYAN AGAINST OWNERSHIP BY THE GOVERNMENT

Gives Newlands Committee His Views on Railroad Control.

COMPETITION PREFERABLE.

Federal Regulation Should Not Be Allowed to Exclude Exercise of State Authority, He Contends—Thinks Railroad Stocks Should Represent Actual Value and Be Stable as Government Bonds.

Washington, Dec. 11.—William J. Bryan, who started the country ten years ago by advocating government ownership of railroads, appeared before the Newlands Joint Committee on Interstate Commerce last week in support of the claim that the states should be allowed to retain authority over the regulation of all transportation lines within their borders. Mr. Bryan explained that he had long regarded government ownership as inevitable, but only because of railroad opposition to effective regulation.

Against Government Ownership. "Personally I cannot say that I desire government ownership," he explained, "because I lean to the individual idea rather than to the collective idea; that is, I believe that government ownership is desirable only where competition is impossible."

Alfred P. Thom, counsel to the Railway Executives' Advisory Committee, previously had presented before the members of the Newlands Committee as one of his reasons for urging a better balanced and more systematic regulation of railroads the argument that this is the only alternative to government ownership. Calling attention to the restrictions imposed upon the transportation lines by conflicting state laws and regulations, to the practical cessation of new construction and to the impossibility under existing conditions of securing the new capital needed for extensions and betterments of railway facilities, he warned the Congressmen that unless they provided a fair and reasonable system of regulation that would enable the railroads to meet the growing needs of the country's business the national government would be compelled to take over the ownership of the lines with all the evils attendant upon such a system.

Preservation of Competition.

Mr. Bryan, on the other hand, holds that the further extension of federal authority over the railroads would be a step in the direction of government ownership. He advanced the view that the centralization of control in the hands of the national government would impose too great a burden upon the regulating body, would offer strong temptation to railroads to interfere in politics and would encourage the general movement toward centralization of power in the federal government at the expense of the states. He said that he did not object to consolidations of railroad lines so long as they did not destroy competition, that he knew of no complaint against great railway systems because of their size and that he believed that the preservation of competition was the test to be applied to all consolidations.

Regulation of Securities.

Mr. Bryan declared himself in favor of national regulation of railway stock and bond issues, but added that he saw no reason why that should exclude the states from acting on the same subject as to state corporations. "I would like to see the stock of a railroad, as long as it is in private hands, made as substantial and as unvarying as the value of a government bond," he asserted.

He suggested that railroad capitalization be readjusted to equalize it with actual valuation of the property represented, making due allowance for equities, and that when this was done the roads should be allowed to earn sufficient income to keep their stock par and to create a surplus. The latter, he tentatively proposed, might be allowed to amount to 25 per cent of the capital.

Railway Earnings Low.

This subject of railroad capitalization and the amount of railroad earnings received further attention from the committee during its recent sessions. In answer to questions by Senator Cummins, Mr. Thom submitted figures showing the net earnings of the roads in recent years. These figures show that during the five years from 1905 to 1910 the average net earnings were 5.25 per cent of the net capitalization, while for the five years from 1910 to 1915 the average was only 4.36 per cent. The total earnings on the stock, computed by adding to the net operating income the income from the securities owned and deducting bond interest, were for 1910, 7.69 per cent; for 1911, 6.14 per cent; for 1912, 4.97 per cent; for 1913, 5.34 per cent; for 1914, 4.06 per cent; for 1915, 3.44 per cent, thus showing an almost continuous decrease throughout this six year period. It was announced that Halford Erickson, formerly chairman of the Wisconsin Railroad Commission, would submit more complete information on this subject to the committee at a later date.

How's This?

We offer One Hundred Dollars Reward for any case of Catarrh that cannot be cured by Hall's Catarrh Medicine. Hall's Catarrh Medicine has been taken by catarrh sufferers for the past thirty-five years, and has become known as the most reliable remedy for Catarrh. Hall's Catarrh Medicine acts thru the Blood on the Mucous surfaces, expelling the Poison from the Blood and healing the diseased portions. After you have taken Hall's Catarrh Medicine for a short time you will see a great improvement in your general health. Start taking Hall's Catarrh Medicine at once and get rid of catarrh. Send for testimonials, free. F. J. CHENEY & CO., Toledo, Ohio. Sold by all Druggists. 7c.



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PLAN DRASTIC TAX

Bitter Feeling May Result in "Soak" for Newspapers

The situation as to the war tax on newspapers still waits for the action of the house ways and means committee. If possible the tax will be levied either upon the advertising or the pound rate by the zone system.

Representative John W. Garner of Texas is the man who has taken charge of the preliminaries for the imposition of this tax, and Garner is greatly impressed with the absurd statements so frequently put forth to the effect that the government pays the publishers a subsidy of \$88,000,000 or \$90,000,000 a year. He thinks this sum might be returned by a tax of some kind.

One of the suggestions is the Randall zone scheme, which was beaten in the last congress and which would have caused publishers an immeasurable amount of trouble.

There prevails in congress an idea that this is a good time to "soak" the newspapers and periodicals. It is a fact, which publishers do not seem to realize, that the press is in disfavor. Many liberal minded men are severe in their criticisms, for it is doubtful if any public man has escaped entirely the sting of public criticism.

Owing to this feeling there is grave danger of a taxation measure which will cost the newspapers heavily. Some of the schemes proposed would drive many publishers out of existence. And what is strange—to those who do not realize the feeling in congress—many men of prominence, even presidential candidates, say it would be a good thing if a lot of publications were forced to suspend.

Statements have been made time after time that from 60 to 75 per cent of the membership of the house of representatives were driven by the press to vote for a war they did not want.

"Now let's make 'em help pay for the war they have brought upon the country," is a sentiment often heard expressed about the capitol.

Representative Garner has said he would like to have the publishers propose a fair and equitable basis for increasing the rate. He announces he is against the subsidy paid in postage; that no business ought to continue that has to have the support of the government, such as is given to publications by the present rate of second class postage. He asserts that if the publishers cannot propose a rate of increase the ways and means committee will do the best it can with the information at hand.

Here is an implied doubt, and it means that the publishers throughout the country must make it plain to their senators and representatives that with the great increase in the price of paper they cannot stand the imposition of a tax such as has been proposed.

Milking-Machine Progress

With commendable diligence the office of farm management of the U. S. department of agriculture has taken up the matter of milking machines as most dairymen would like to see it done. Not content with the reports of the various experiment stations on the subject, W. J. Spillman

in charge of the work, sent some of his men out into the dairy districts to talk with men who were using milking machines on their farms.

A good many valuable things were learned, which are included in Professional Paper No. 423 of the department. Two main questions, however, were asked all the dairymen using milking machines. The first was: "Has the use of a mechanical milker influenced the production of your herd?" There were 156 answers as follows: No difference observed, 124; less production, 16; more production, 16.

The second question was: "Do you find that the machine has magnified or lessened sore teats, spider in the teats, garget, milk fever, and other udder troubles?" To this question there were 129 answers: No difference observed, 110; less trouble from udder diseases, 11; more trouble, 8. Practical investigations of this kind, made from time to time as new methods of farm management develop, are of great help in keeping the country abreast of the times. Individual dairymen will always have to draw their own conclusions concerning their specific problems, but it gives them something definite on which to base their judgment.—Farm and Fireside.

Getting Rid of Flies

Soon will come again the season for exploiting the prize folly—that of clubs and other organizations announcing prizes to go to boys and girls who bring in the greatest number of flies. In these contests children, often mere tots, are encouraged to handle these spreaders of fever and carriers of filth.

How soon, think you, would it be possible to rid any given district of malaria or yellow fever by distributing prizes to the boys and girls who might bring in the most pints, quarts or even bushels of mosquitoes? How soon would a similar program have brought about such results as came of the work in the Canal zone? We might, though, just as reasonably expect to banish typhoid or yellow fever without giving attention to drainage, cleanliness, screens and the use of oil, or to fight typhoid by killing quantities of flies while leaving undisturbed the manure heap, the insanitary outhouse, and the pile of decaying garbage.

It is perfectly proper for us to swat the fly and to kill and trap as best we may this filthy foe. Right now, though, it is doubly important that the source of the trouble be reached, that everywhere thorough campaigns be conducted to kill the fly before he flies. Better, instead of prizes for dead flies, would be premiums for sanitary surroundings.

Wise is the club that sounds the call for a campaign of cleanliness. If there are prizes, they will may be for the safe home, the sanitary city—yes, and for the clean country, since the country is the commissary department of the city. The city of any considerable size has certain sanitary regulations that must be observed. Furthermore, the municipal water supply is safeguarded. Not so in the country, where each farm is largely a kingdom unto itself, and where reasonable sanitary rules are not always observed. Because this

is true, typhoid has very largely become a disease of the farm and of the small town.

Why not, then, on every farm a clean-up campaign? Well might there be a special clean-up day with prizes for proficiency. Can we imagine a greater health help?

Fighting filth is fighting flies. It is, in truth, getting the fly before it flies. With a campaign conducted along these lines there will be less disease, and fewer flies to swat.

ROADS INSPECTED

Engineer Nunn Comes From Salem View County Highways

The county court Tuesday had as its guest Herbert Nunn, the new state highway engineer, and the group made a trip of inspection over several of the important roads of the county. Mr. Nunn traveled over the paved roads between Oregon City and Portland and told the court that practically the entire length of the road would be connected with bond issue pavement, in case the issue is authorized in June.

In one or two places the engineer suggested that curves would have to be eliminated. Mr. Nunn also traveled over the road between Oregon City and Canby. Here he told the court that grades would have to be cut down, but that the road in the main could be paved and that it will probably be recommended as one of the first for hard surface.

Mr. Nunn approved the route of the west side road through West Linn and Oswego to Portland and aside from advising a cut to reduce several grades believed it would answer the requirements of the highway commission.

Spring Colds Are the Worst

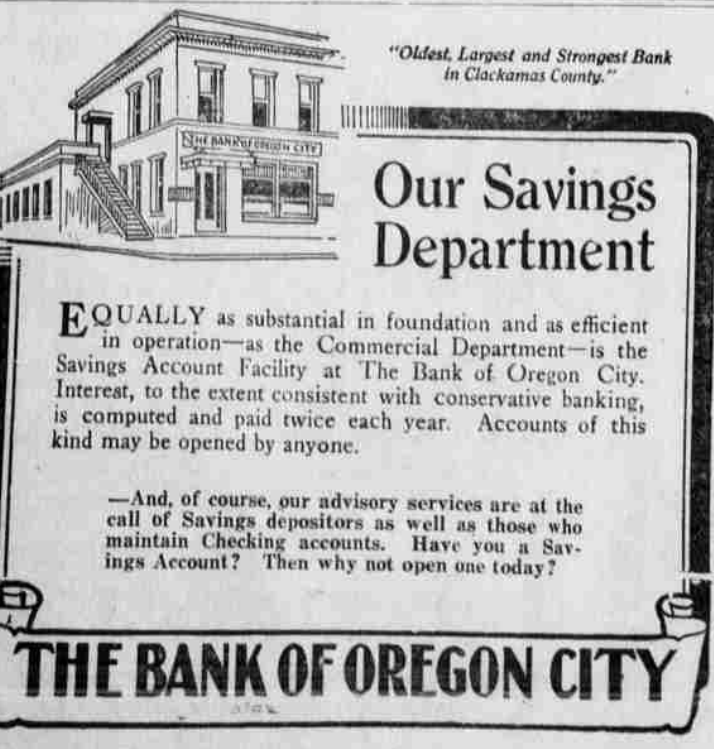
They lead to catarrh and pneumonia. They weaken the entire system and leave it unable to resist the sudden changes. They interfere with your digestion and lessen your activity. Neglected they soon become that dread disease known as systemic catarrh. Don't neglect them. It's costly as well as dangerous.

PERUNA Will Safeguard You

Have a box of Peruna Tablets with you for the sudden cold or exposure. Tame your system up with a regular course of the liquid Peruna, fortify it against colds, get your digestion up to normal, take care of yourself, and avoid danger. If you are suffering now begin the treatment at once. Give Nature the help she needs to throw off the catarrhal inflammation, and again become well.

Peruna has been helping people for 44 years. Thousands of homes rely on it for coughs, cold and indigestion. It's a good tonic for the weak, as well.

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